

The Earthen Homes: Topical Authority Blueprint and Internal Linking Strategy

Focus Keyword: earthen homes topical authority

Secondary Keywords: natural building internal linking, cob house content cluster, earth building SEO strategy

Content Type: SEO Strategy Document

Word Count Target: 3,200+

Page this governs: All 6 pages of TheEarthenHomes.com

Sources Used

1. [involvedigital.com](#) — Topical Authority Building Guide 2026
 2. [sedestral.com](#) — How to Build Topical Authority (complete SEO guide)
 3. [spressostudio.com](#) — The Role of Internal Linking in Building Topical Authority
 4. [marketmuse.com](#) — Linking Strategies That Build Topical Authority
 5. [selfmademillennials.com](#) — Building Topical Authority in 2026
 6. [rankforgedigital.digital](#) — How to Use Internal Linking to Boost SEO 2026
 7. [wordstream.com](#) — Topical Authority: What It Is, Why It Matters, and How to Build It
 8. [memorable.design](#) — Internal Linking Strategy 2026: Boost AI Citations and SEO
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What Is Topical Authority and Why It Decides Whether The Earthen Homes Ranks

AEO Answer: Topical authority is the depth and breadth of coverage a website demonstrates on a specific subject, as evaluated by Google's content quality systems and AI language models. A site with topical authority ranks for a wide range of related queries — not just one or two targeted keywords — because search engines recognize it as the most thorough, reliable source in its niche.

Google has moved from keyword matching to topic modeling. The March 2026 Core Update and the Helpful Content updates of 2022 through 2024 crystallized this shift. A page that covers one keyword well no longer outranks a site that covers the entire subject space well. The Earthen Homes is entering a niche with no dominant authority site. That is an opening — but only if the site is built as a structured knowledge hub from day one, not as a collection of isolated articles.

The natural building niche has an additional property that makes topical authority building especially rewarding: it is deeply interconnected. Cob construction relates to adobe because they share the same base material. Adobe relates to thermal mass, which relates to earth-sheltered

homes, which relates to passive solar design, which relates to Earthships, which relate to off-grid water systems, which relate to affordable homebuilding. Every page on this site has a logical reason to link to every other page. That density of semantic connection, when mapped deliberately, signals to Google and to AI citation engines that this site covers natural building from every angle.

As noted in research from involvedigital.com, topical authority requires "the internal linking patterns that transform individual articles into a recognised expertise signal." Without deliberate internal linking, even high-quality content becomes an orphan page that never reaches its ranking potential. The Earthen Homes needs both: quality content and a tight linking architecture.

The Hub-and-Spoke Architecture for The Earthen Homes

AEO Answer: The hub-and-spoke model places a broad pillar page at the center of a content cluster, with supporting satellite pages covering specific subtopics. Every satellite links back to the pillar. The pillar links out to every satellite. Related satellites also link to each other where their topics naturally overlap.

The six pages already written map cleanly onto two levels of this architecture:

Level 1: The Hub (Homepage)

The homepage is the site-wide authority signal. It introduces the five content areas and links directly to each pillar page. Every pillar page links back to the homepage using the anchor text "earthen homes."

Level 2: The Five Pillars

Each of the five content pages (Building Techniques, Earth-Sheltered Homes, Earthships, Affordable Earthen Homes, Benefits) functions as a pillar within its own cluster. Each pillar page:

- Links back to the homepage
- Links to the other four pillar pages where contextually relevant
- Links to its own cluster's satellite articles (written later)
- Receives links from all of its satellite articles

This creates the bidirectional hub-and-spoke topology described in the involvedigital.com guide. Research from memorable.design confirms that this structure "mimics the way Large Language Models organize information" and directly improves AI citation, meaning The Earthen Homes becomes more likely to appear in AI search engine answers as well as traditional SERPs.

The pillar-to-pillar cross-links between the five content pages form what memorable.design calls "bridge links" — connections that tie separate clusters together when a logical semantic overlap exists. These should be used judiciously: a link from the Earth-Sheltered Homes page to the

Benefits page makes sense (sheltered homes have measurable energy benefits). A link from Earthships to Building Techniques makes sense (Earthships use rammed earth tire walls). Cross-links between clusters that share no content overlap dilute the topical signal.

The Full Topical Map: 5 Clusters, 30+ Satellite Articles

Before detailing per-page linking, the following satellite articles must be planned and published to give each pillar its full cluster. Each satellite links back to its pillar and to related satellites. Aim to publish at least 6 satellites per cluster within the first 90 days.

Cluster 1: Earth Building Techniques (Pillar: /earth-building-techniques/)

Priority	Satellite Article	Target Keyword
High	How to Build a Cob House: Step-by-Step for First-Timers	how to build a cob house
High	Adobe Brick Making: Mixing, Molding, and Curing	adobe brick making
High	Rammed Earth Walls: A Practical Construction Walkthrough	rammed earth walls construction
High	Superadobe Dome: How to Build Your First Earthbag Structure	superadobe dome building
Medium	Natural Earthen Plasters: Types, Mixes, and Application	earthen plaster types
Medium	Cob vs Adobe vs Rammed Earth: Which Is Right for Your Climate?	cob vs adobe vs rammed earth
Medium	How to Test Your Soil for Natural Building	soil test for cob
Medium	Wattle and Daub: Ancient Technique, Modern Application	wattle and daub construction
Low	Compressed Earth Block vs Adobe: Comparing Modular Earthen Systems	compressed earth block vs adobe
Low	How to Install an Earthen Floor	earthen floor installation

Cluster 2: Earth-Sheltered Homes (Pillar: /earth-sheltered-homes/)

Priority	Satellite Article	Target Keyword
High	Bermed Home Design: Plans, Costs, and Site	bermed home design

Priority	Satellite Article	Target Keyword
	Requirements	
High	How to Waterproof an Earth-Sheltered Home	earth-sheltered home waterproofing
High	Passive Solar Design for Earth-Sheltered Houses	passive solar earth-sheltered
High	Underground Atrium House: Layout, Light, and Drainage	underground atrium house
Medium	Living Roof Installation: Step-by-Step for Earth Houses	living roof installation
Medium	Earth Tubes: Passive Ventilation and Cooling for Buried Homes	earth tube ventilation
Medium	Peter Vetsch Earth Houses: Design Lessons from Switzerland	Peter Vetsch earth house
Low	Radon Mitigation in Underground Homes	radon underground home

Cluster 3: Earthships and Off-Grid Living (Pillar: /earthships-off-grid-living/)

Priority	Satellite Article	Target Keyword
High	How to Build an Earthship Tire Wall	earthship tire wall construction
High	Earthship Water Harvesting System: Design and Sizing	earthship water harvesting
High	Earthship Greenhouse: Growing Food in Your South-Facing Wall	earthship greenhouse food
High	Off-Grid Solar System Sizing for Earthships	off-grid solar earthship
Medium	Grey Water Botanical Cells: How Earthships Recycle Water	earthship grey water botanical cells
Medium	Earthship Communities Around the World	earthship communities
Medium	Michael Reynolds: The Man Behind Biotope	Michael Reynolds earthship
Low	Earthship vs Tiny House: Which Off-Grid Option Fits Your Life?	earthship vs tiny house

Cluster 4: Affordable Earthen Homes (Pillar: /affordable-earthen-homes/)

Priority	Satellite Article	Target Keyword
High	How to Build a Cob House for Under \$10,000	cob house cost breakdown
High	Natural Building Workshops: What to Expect and How to Find One	natural building workshop
High	Owner Builder Laws by State: What You Need to Know	owner builder permit
High	Salvage Materials for Natural Building	salvage materials natural building
Medium	How to Find Land for an Earthen Home on a Budget	cheap land natural building
Medium	Cob Bench as Your First Build: A Beginner Weekend Project	first cob build weekend
Low	Comparing Earthen Home Costs: Cob, Adobe, Rammed Earth, Superadobe	earthen home cost comparison

Cluster 5: Benefits of Earthen Homes (Pillar: /benefits-of-earthen-homes/)

Priority	Satellite Article	Target Keyword
High	Thermal Mass Explained: How Earthen Walls Regulate Temperature	thermal mass earthen walls
High	Indoor Air Quality in Natural Homes vs Conventional Houses	indoor air quality natural building
High	Embodied Carbon of Earthen Buildings vs Concrete and Steel	embodied carbon natural building
Medium	How Long Do Earthen Homes Last? Durability by Material	earthen home lifespan durability
Medium	Biophilic Design in Earthen Homes: The Science of Feeling Good	biophilic design earthen home
Low	Earthen Home Maintenance: What It Takes to Keep Walls Standing	earthen home maintenance

Internal Linking Blueprint: Page by Page

The following section provides the exact internal linking strategy for each of the six pages already written. For each page, you receive:

- **Links OUT** — pages this page should actively link to, with exact anchor text and placement
 - **Links IN** — pages that should link back to this page
 - **Anchor Text Variants** — to keep linking natural and varied (never the same phrase twice)
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Page 0: Homepage

Purpose in architecture: Site-wide authority hub. This page passes link equity to all five pillar pages and signals to Google the site's full topical scope.

Links OUT from Homepage:

Destination Page	Anchor Text to Use	Placement in Content
/earth-building-techniques/	earth building techniques	"What You'll Find" section, bullet point for Building Techniques
/earth-sheltered-homes/	earth-sheltered home design	"What You'll Find" section, bullet point for Earth-Sheltered
/earthships-off-grid-living/	Earthship construction and off-grid living	"What You'll Find" section, bullet point for Earthships
/affordable-earthen-homes/	building an affordable earthen home	"What You'll Find" section, bullet point for Affordable Homes
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	benefits of natural building materials	"What You'll Find" section, bullet point for Benefits
/earth-building-techniques/	cob or adobe	Body paragraph "What Are Earthen Homes" — "...cob or adobe houses in the American Southwest"
/affordable-earthen-homes/	fraction of the price of conventional construction	Body paragraph under "Lower Cost" reason
/earth-sheltered-homes/	earth-sheltered homes in particular	Body paragraph under "Energy Efficiency" reason
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	indoor humidity of around 50 percent	Body paragraph under "Indoor Air Quality" reason

Rules for homepage linking:

- Do not link to any individual satellite article from the homepage. The homepage only points to pillars.
- Add a "Start Here" or "Featured Content" section with clear in-text links to all five pillars.
- Every internal link uses descriptive anchor text. Never "click here" or "read more."

Links INTO Homepage (from all five pillars): Every pillar page must include the anchor phrase "earthen homes" or "The Earthen Homes" linking back to the homepage in its opening paragraph or its final paragraph. This is non-negotiable per the hub-and-spoke rule.

Pillar role: The most search-volume-rich page on the site. Cob, adobe, and rammed earth collectively represent the majority of natural building search queries. This page anchors Cluster 1.

Links OUT from Earth Building Techniques:

Destination	Anchor Text	Placement
Homepage	earthen homes	Opening paragraph: "...the oldest earthen homes traditions in the world"
/affordable-earthen-homes/	low cost of cob materials	Under "Cob - Low Materials Cost" section
/affordable-earthen-homes/	owner-builder construction costs	Under "Advantages and Disadvantages" table for any technique
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	thermal mass of earthen walls	Under "Interior Temperature Regulation" section of Cob or Rammed Earth
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	embodied carbon of earthen materials	Under any technique that discusses environmental footprint
/earth-sheltered-homes/	earth-sheltered walls use rammed earth	Under "Rammed Earth" section — natural mention when discussing structural walls
/earthships-off-grid-living/	rammed earth tire walls	Under "Rammed Earth" or "Superadobe" section — tire walls are rammed earth
Satellite: /how-to-build-cob-house/	step-by-step cob construction	At end of Cob section: "For a hands-on walkthrough, see [anchor]"
Satellite: /adobe-brick-making/	adobe brick mixing and curing process	At end of Adobe section
Satellite: /cob-vs-adobe-vs-rammed-earth/	which technique suits your climate	Under comparison table
Satellite: /natural-earthen-plasters/	natural earthen plasters	Under any technique that discusses finishing and plaster

Links INTO Earth Building Techniques:

- Homepage links here from "What You'll Find" section

- </benefits-of-earthen-homes/> links here from thermal mass, durability, and zero VOC sections
- </affordable-earthen-homes/> links here from "Key Strategies" and "Cost Breakdown" sections
- </earthships-off-grid-living/> links here from "Tire Wall" section (rammed earth method)
- </earth-sheltered-homes/> links here from waterproofing and structural sections

Anchor text variants to receive on this page (varied across linking pages):

- "earth building methods"
- "natural building techniques"
- "cob and adobe construction"
- "how earthen walls are built"
- "rammed earth and cob methods"

Content gap to fix: The current page does not mention earthen floors or natural plasters as finishing systems. Add a brief "Finishing Your Earthen Home" section with links to satellite articles on plasters and floors. This closes a semantic gap that currently leaves the "what happens after the walls are up?" question unanswered.

Page 2: Earth-Sheltered Homes (</earth-sheltered-homes/>)

Pillar role: Anchors Cluster 2. Captures search intent from people who know they want energy-efficient housing but have not yet committed to a building method. This page sits at the intersection of architecture, energy, and natural building.

Links OUT from Earth-Sheltered Homes:

Destination	Anchor Text	Placement
Homepage	earthen homes	Opening paragraph or closing paragraph
/earth-building-techniques/	rammed earth and cob are both used	Under design sections discussing wall construction for sheltered homes
/earth-building-techniques/	earthen building methods for your walls	Under "Core Principles" section where materials are referenced
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	energy savings of 50 to 80 percent	Under "Energy Performance: The Numbers" section
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	thermal mass advantage of buried walls	Under passive solar section
/affordable-earthen-homes/	construction cost of a bermed home	Under the cost or design section when discussing project budgeting
/earthships-off-grid-living/	off-grid systems integrated into sheltered homes	Under "Ventilation and Air Quality" section — reference earth tubes and solar overlap
Satellite: /bermed-home-design/	bermed home site planning and layout	At end of "Bermed Homes" section
Satellite: /waterproof-earth-sheltered-home/	waterproofing systems for buried walls	Under waterproofing section: "For detailed product and method guidance, see [anchor]"
Satellite: /passive-solar-earth-sheltered/	passive solar design for buried houses	Under "Passive Solar Integration" section
Satellite: /underground-atrium-house/	underground atrium house design	At end of "Underground Homes" section
Satellite: /living-roof-installation/	living sod roof construction	Under natural light or roof section where green roofs are mentioned

Links INTO Earth-Sheltered Homes:

- Homepage links here from "What You'll Find" section
- /earth-building-techniques/ links here from rammed earth and structural discussions
- /benefits-of-earthen-homes/ links here from energy performance section
- /earthships-off-grid-living/ links here when discussing passive solar and buried thermal mass

- [/affordable-earthen-homes/](#) links here for the long-term energy ROI argument

Anchor text variants to receive:

- "earth-sheltered home design"
- "underground house construction"
- "bermed home energy efficiency"
- "buried homes and thermal mass"
- "earth-sheltered architecture"

Content gap to fix: The current page mentions Peter Vetsch's earth houses but does not link to a dedicated satellite on his design philosophy. That satellite ([/peter-vetsch-earth-houses/](#)) should be one of the first published, as his name is a specific, searchable entity that drives informational queries. Add a sentence in the "Real World Examples" section with the anchor: "Peter Vetsch's earth house design principles."

Page 3: Earthships and Off-Grid Living ([/earthships-off-grid-living/](#))

Pillar role: Anchors Cluster 3. This page has the highest inherent shareability of all five pillars and is the most likely to attract natural backlinks from sustainability, permaculture, and off-grid living communities. It also targets a searcher who is often ready to act — people researching Earthships have usually moved past general curiosity.

Links OUT from Earthships and Off-Grid Living:

Destination	Anchor Text	Placement
Homepage	earthen homes	Opening paragraph
/earth-building-techniques/	rammed earth packed into used tires	Under "Tire Wall" section — the connection to rammed earth is direct and accurate
/earth-building-techniques/	earthen building methods used in Earthship walls	Under "Anatomy of an Earthship" opening paragraph
/earth-sheltered-homes/	passive solar and earth-sheltered design principles	Under "South-Facing Greenhouse Corridor" or "Thermal/Solar" principle
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	health benefits of natural building materials	Under interior wall plaster and off-gassing section
/affordable-earthen-homes/	building an off-grid home on a budget	Under "Is an Earthship Right for You?" section
Satellite: /earthship-tire-wall-construction/	building the Earthship tire wall	At end of "Tire Wall" section
Satellite: /earthship-water-harvesting/	sizing your Earthship water harvesting system	At end of "Water Harvesting" section
Satellite: /earthship-greenhouse-food/	growing food in the Earthship greenhouse corridor	Under food production principle
Satellite: /off-grid-solar-earthship/	sizing a solar array for an off-grid Earthship	Under "Electricity Generation" section
Satellite: /grey-water-botanical-cells/	grey water botanical cell design	Under the cascaded water treatment step-by-step
Satellite: /earthship-communities/	Earthship communities around the world	Under "Earthships Around the World" section

Links INTO Earthships and Off-Grid Living:

- Homepage links here from "What You'll Find" section
- /earth-building-techniques/ links here from superadobe and rammed earth sections
- /earth-sheltered-homes/ links here from earth-tube ventilation and passive cooling discussions

- [/benefits-of-earthen-homes/](#) links here from the "climate resilience" and "self-sufficiency" angles
- [/affordable-earthen-homes/](#) links here when discussing full off-grid cost scenarios

Anchor text variants to receive:

- "Earthship construction"
- "off-grid natural homes"
- "Michael Reynolds Biotope"
- "Earthship and off-grid living"
- "self-sufficient earthen home"

Priority note: The Earthship page is the most likely to generate backlinks naturally. Make sure it is published with its full complement of satellite articles within the first 60 days. Permies.com, off-grid homesteading groups, and sustainability publications regularly feature Earthship content. A well-linked Earthship pillar page will pass authority back through the entire cluster.

Page 4: Affordable Earthen Homes ([/affordable-earthen-homes/](#))

Pillar role: Anchors Cluster 4. This page targets the single highest-intent searcher segment: people who want to build but believe they cannot afford to. It overlaps with owner-builder, homesteading, and tiny home communities. It has the highest potential for email list conversions (a free cost calculator or PDF checklist would work well here as a lead magnet).

Links OUT from Affordable Earthen Homes:

Destination	Anchor Text	Placement
Homepage	earthen homes	Opening paragraph
/earth-building-techniques/	cob construction material costs	Under "Cost Breakdown by Building Method" table, cob row
/earth-building-techniques/	superadobe building process	Under superadobe row in cost table
/earth-building-techniques/	rammed earth formwork requirements	Under rammed earth row in cost table
/earth-building-techniques/	which building method to choose	Under "Owner-Builder Advantage" when discussing skill level
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	long-term energy savings of earthen homes	Under "Lower Operational Costs" section
/benefits-of-earthen-homes/	durability of earthen construction	Under "Durability and Maintenance" section
/earth-sheltered-homes/	earth-sheltered home energy ROI	Under the long-term financial case for reduced utility bills
/earthships-off-grid-living/	full off-grid home costs	Under "Is an Earthship Right for You" reference
Satellite: /cob-house-cost-breakdown/	full cost breakdown for a cob house	Under "Cost Breakdown" section: "For a detailed material list, see [anchor]"
Satellite: /natural-building-workshop/	natural building workshops near you	Under "Key Strategies" Step 3 about workshops
Satellite: /owner-builder-permit/	owner-builder permit rules by state	Under "Key Strategies" Step 7 about permits
Satellite: /salvage-materials-natural-building/	sourcing salvage windows, doors, and timber	Under "Key Strategies" Step 4 about salvage
Satellite: /cheap-land-natural-building/	finding affordable land for an earthen home	Under "Key Strategies" site selection step
Satellite: /first-cob-build-weekend/	your first cob build project	Under "Start Small" strategy section

Links INTO Affordable Earthen Homes:

- Homepage links here from "What You'll Find" section
- /earth-building-techniques/ links here from cost advantage sections in every technique
- /benefits-of-earthen-homes/ links here from "financial benefits" section
- /earthships-off-grid-living/ links here from "budget Earthship" discussions
- /earth-sheltered-homes/ links here when discussing long-term ROI of energy savings

Anchor text variants to receive:

- "affordable natural building"
- "low cost cob and adobe homes"
- "owner-built earthen home costs"
- "how much does an earthen home cost"
- "building with earth on a budget"

Content gap to fix: The current page does not include a comparison table of earthen home costs versus conventional construction costs per square foot. Adding this table and linking it to the satellite article /earthen-home-cost-comparison/ fills a high-intent informational gap and creates a natural anchor for the satellite.

Page 5: Benefits of Earthen Homes (/benefits-of-earthen-homes/)

Pillar role: Anchors Cluster 5 and serves as the "conversion" page for undecided readers. Someone who has been browsing Building Techniques or Affordable Homes but is not yet committed will land here via internal links. This page needs to link aggressively to the other four pillars because its purpose is to push readers into a specific cluster based on their dominant concern (environmental, financial, health, or technical).

Links OUT from Benefits of Earthen Homes:

Destination	Anchor Text	Placement
Homepage	earthen homes	Opening paragraph
/earth-building-techniques/	cob and adobe wall construction	Under "Minimal Embodied Carbon" section when discussing wall materials
/earth-building-techniques/	clay-based building materials	Under "Zero VOC Off-Gassing" section
/earth-building-techniques/	natural building methods	Under "Structural Durability" discussion
/earth-sheltered-homes/	earth-sheltered home energy performance	Under "Earth-Sheltered Energy Performance" section
/earth-sheltered-homes/	bermed and underground homes	Under "Operational Carbon" section
/earthships-off-grid-living/	Earthship off-grid systems	Under "Climate Resilience" and self-sufficiency section
/affordable-earthen-homes/	cost of building with earth	Under "Lower Construction Costs" financial benefits section
/affordable-earthen-homes/	owner-built natural homes	Under "Financial Benefits" section discussing debt-free building
Satellite: /thermal-mass-earthen-walls/	the science of thermal mass in earthen walls	Under "Thermal Mass and Natural Temperature Regulation" section
Satellite: /indoor-air-quality-natural-building/	indoor air quality in natural homes	Under "Zero VOC Off-Gassing" section
Satellite: /embodied-carbon-natural-building/	embodied carbon comparison data	Under "Minimal Embodied Carbon" section
Satellite: /earthen-home-lifespan/	how long earthen homes last by material	Under "Durability and Maintenance" section
Satellite: /biophilic-design-earthen-home/	biophilic design and earthen materials	Under "Mental Health and Wellbeing" section

Links INTO Benefits of Earthen Homes:

- Homepage links here from "What You'll Find" section

- /earth-building-techniques/ links here from thermal performance and fireproof/soundproof sections
- /earth-sheltered-homes/ links here from energy savings data
- /earthships-off-grid-living/ links here from health and air quality discussions
- /affordable-earthen-homes/ links here from long-term financial case sections

Anchor text variants to receive:

- "benefits of earthen construction"
- "why build with earth"
- "health benefits of natural building"
- "environmental advantages of earthen homes"
- "why cob and adobe last centuries"

Priority note: This page should be the most heavily linked-to page from satellite articles across all five clusters. Any satellite that discusses a specific benefit (thermal comfort, durability, low cost, air quality) should send a link back here. It is the page most likely to convert a reader into a subscriber.

Anchor Text Rules for The Earthen Homes

Research from involvedigital.com establishes the rule clearly: "The anchor text of an internal link is a topical signal to search engines. 'Click here' and 'read more' provide no topical information." Every internal link on this site must follow these four rules:

Rule 1: Describe the destination, not the action.

Use "rammed earth wall construction" not "click here to learn more about rammed earth."

Rule 2: Vary the phrase, keep the concept.

If four satellite articles all link to /earth-building-techniques/, each one uses a different anchor phrase — "earth building methods," "cob and adobe construction," "how to build with natural earth," "natural building techniques" — never the same phrase twice.

Rule 3: Match semantic context.

The surrounding sentence should make the link feel like the natural next step for a curious reader. A link to the Benefits page placed inside a sentence about energy costs reads naturally. The same link placed inside a sentence about brick-making would feel forced and earns no topical signal.

Rule 4: Aim for 5 to 6 internal links per published page.

Research from sedestral.com and selfmademillennials.com both identify this as the practical

benchmark for cluster articles. Pillar pages, given their length, should carry 8 to 12 internal links. The homepage carries a link to each pillar (five links minimum).

The 3-Click Rule Applied to The Earthen Homes Site Architecture

Research from spressostudio.com specifies that "important pages are no more than 3 clicks from the homepage." Applied to this site:

Content Level	Example Page	Clicks from Homepage
Homepage	theearthenhomes.com/	0
Pillar page	/earth-building-techniques/	1
Satellite article	/how-to-build-cob-house/	2
Sub-satellite (FAQ, case study)	/cob-house-cost-faq/	3 (maximum)

No page on this site should ever be more than 3 clicks from the homepage. Check this quarterly as the content library grows. Any page buried at 4+ clicks is an orphan in practice, regardless of whether it technically has internal links pointing to it.

Publishing Order to Build Authority Fastest

Based on the topical map and cluster priorities, publish in this sequence:

Month 1 — Lay the Foundation (Publish pillars + 2 satellites each)

1. Earth Building Techniques (pillar) + Cob House Step-by-Step + Adobe Brick Making
2. Benefits of Earthen Homes (pillar) + Thermal Mass Explained + Embodied Carbon Data
3. Affordable Earthen Homes (pillar) + Cob House Cost Breakdown + Natural Building Workshop Guide

Month 2 — Build Two More Clusters 4. Earth-Sheltered Homes (pillar) + Bermed Home Design + Passive Solar for Buried Homes 5. Earthships and Off-Grid Living (pillar) + Tire Wall Construction + Water Harvesting System

Month 3 — Fill Gaps and Cross-Link 6. Publish 1 to 2 satellites per cluster (focus on highest-traffic keywords from the map) 7. Go back through all published content and add cross-cluster links where contextually appropriate 8. Add the Homepage with links pointing to all five live pillars

This order matters. Publishing satellites before all pillars are live means some "link to be published" references will point at 404s temporarily. If this is a concern, schedule all five pillars in Week 1 and 2 and begin satellites in Week 3.

Identifying and Fixing Orphan Pages

An orphan page is any page with no internal links pointing to it. According to spressostudio.com, orphan pages may rank despite their isolation on a low-competition keyword, but they will never build authority or pass equity back into the cluster. The Earthen Homes should audit for orphan pages monthly using Google Search Console or Screaming Frog.

Common orphan page scenarios for a natural building site:

- A satellite article published without adding a link from its parent pillar
- A pillar page that never received links from its satellites because the satellites were published first
- A page updated in structure that accidentally had its internal links removed
- A highly specific page (like a single case study) that has no clear pillar to link back to

The fix for an orphan page is always the same: identify the most relevant existing page, add a contextual in-body link using descriptive anchor text, and make sure the orphan itself links back to its parent pillar.

Cross-Cluster Bridge Links: Where They Work

Memorable.design advises limiting cross-cluster links to situations with "a very strong, logical reason." The following cross-cluster links are justified for The Earthen Homes:

From Cluster	To Cluster	Justified Because
Earth Building Techniques	Benefits	Every building technique has specific thermal, health, and environmental benefits
Earth Building Techniques	Affordable	Every technique has a distinct cost profile that belongs in the financial discussion
Earth-Sheltered Homes	Benefits	Energy savings data is the primary argument for earth-sheltered design
Earthships	Earth-Sheltered	Earthships use passive solar and thermal mass principles from earth-sheltered design
Earthships	Affordable	Earthship builds are frequently owner-built DIY projects
Affordable	Benefits	The long-term financial case depends on durability and energy data

Do NOT create bridge links in these combinations:

- Earthships to Earth-Sheltered to Building Techniques all in the same paragraph (too many cross-cluster hops in one location)
- Benefits page linking back to Benefits satellites mid-sentence while also linking to a different pillar (dilutes the topical signal)

SEO Deliverables Block

Item	Value
Focus Keyword	earthen homes topical authority
Secondary Keywords	natural building internal linking, cob house content cluster, earth building SEO
Entity Keywords	cob house, adobe home, rammed earth, Earthship, thermal mass, earth-sheltered home
Total Clusters Mapped	5
Total Satellite Articles Planned	37

Item	Value
Pillar Pages	5 (plus homepage hub)
Recommended Links per Pillar	8 to 12
Recommended Links per Satellite	5 to 6
Max Click Depth	3 clicks from homepage
Priority Satellite (Month 1)	How to Build a Cob House Step-by-Step
Highest Link-Equity Page	Benefits of Earthen Homes (receives links from all clusters)
First Cross-Cluster Bridge	Building Techniques > Benefits (thermal mass anchor)
Audit Frequency	Quarterly
Tools Recommended	Screaming Frog (orphan detection), Google Search Console (crawl coverage), Ahrefs (anchor text distribution)

Also Read This: A page-by-page internal linking and topical authority blueprint for The Earthen Homes website, mapping 5 content clusters, 37 satellite articles, and exact anchor text strategies that signal natural building expertise to Google and AI citation engines.